



Diaspora—regain your privacy on social networks

The intriguing idea of creating an open-source, decentralised, personally controlled, distributed social network where each person's data and privacy is under his or her own control, has grabbed the imaginations of thousands of people who have had enough of arrogant and invasive policies and actions.

The four students at NYU's Courant Institute expected they would need three to four months to write the code, so for living expenses in that time, they turned to Kickstarter.com, a site which helps creative people find support. They asked for US\$ 10,000 within 39 days, if they were to develop the code.

The response was staggering. They reached their \$10,000 goal in 12 days, and the money continues to pour in; as of this writing, 5285 backers have pledged \$175,206 (!!); check out the final figure on or after 1st June, at <http://goo.gl/PGkM>



Diaspora aims to be a distributed network, where totally separate computers connect to each other directly, so users can connect without surrendering privacy. These computers, called 'seeds', are owned by users, and hosted by users (or on a rented server). Once set up, a seed will aggregate all of your information: your Facebook profile, tweets, anything. An easily

extendable plug-in framework will allow new types of content and connections to be automatically integrated into every seed. More at: <http://goo.gl/LYN3> and <http://goo.gl/T4P93>

Mandriva S.A. for sale

The Paris-based Mandriva S.A., which has been developing the popular Mandriva Linux distribution for over a decade, is for sale. The story from the French Mandriva forums is that the company's financial situation has deteriorated rapidly this year, and selling is the only remaining option.

Two potential buyers are apparently in the running: London-based lightapp Ltd, and Linagora from France. More at: <http://goo.gl/hGsl>



Kernel 2.6.34 released

Linus Torvalds has released version 2.6.34 of the Linux kernel. Like the previous two releases, the latest kernel offers numerous improvements to the kernel infrastructure, as well as hundreds of new and improved drivers. For instance, Linux 2.6.34 supports two new filesystems, and can address a few very recent or soon-to-be-expected graphics chips that were not supported in older kernel versions. Various new technologies are to increase data throughput in the communication between guest systems and the outside world. 2.6.34 also has support for some Intel processors and chipsets that Intel plans to introduce early next year. Several other improvements enhance utilisation of the power-saving mechanisms found in modern hardware. Heise's *Kernel Log* (<http://goo.gl/8HGI>) offers an overview of these, and many other new and important features of Linux 2.6.34.

New site launch: LinuxExchange.org

LinuxExchange, built on the StackExchange platform, is intended to be StackOverflow for Linux and Open Source—a collaboratively edited question-and-answer site about Linux and Open Source, with a workflow somewhere between the forums of LinuxQuestions.org and the Mediawiki-based LQ Wiki. While still in beta mode, the site is live, and a few people have already signed up and are asking/answering questions. Given the immense popularity of StackOverflow.com with programmers, and of ServerFault.com with system administrators and IT professionals, this site should to prove to be a valuable source of help and information on all matters FOSS. More at <http://goo.gl/3fMN> and, of course, <http://linuxexchange.org>